

Across Borders: A Better Question

跨越边界：更好的问题

Theme: 旅行、交通与文化交流 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The better question came from a **pedestrian** at a **rural stop**, **late** in the **season**. “Do you **understand** what a **short walk** to the station means here?” she asked. “In the **countryside**, a **walk** is not exercise. It is the whole **approach** to the world.” The team had a **fact**, a **date**, and a **century** of assumption, and none of them answered her.

The **royal reception**, the **agricultural bulletin**, and the local **championship** had all been covered; the scholarship and the fellowship had not. “A **partner** is not a **trainer**,” the **sailor** said. “A **trainee** is not a **medal**.” Their **uniform**, their **tune**, and their **romance** with the city were the **background** of the report, and the report was flattering to the wrong people.

The **dramatic episode**, when it came, was a **telephone** call: the sponsor had abandoned the **membership** list to a **transmitter** in the capital. “I **speak** for the **pedestrian**,” Aisha said. “He is **alone**, and he is not a **cartoon**.” It was a **descriptive** sentence, not a **scholarly** one, and it was the best line in the file.

The false assumption was that a **flourish** in the figures meant a flourishing service. “The **companionship** of the queue is not **an instalment** plan,” the **trainer** said. “You cannot **steer** a village with a spreadsheet.” The **reserved** young man from the lodge, the last **sailor** of the old line, and the manager of the **reception** desk all agreed with him.

After the meeting, the team stopped writing about **colonialism** and began writing about the **stop** itself: who waited there, what they carried, and how long they had been waiting. It was **certainly** a smaller question, and it was **finally** the right one. They thanked the **pedestrian**, ran the numbers again **through** the **month**, and put her sentence at the top. **After** all, the **date** was **far** off, and it was **likely** that the **matter** would **run** into another **month**. **Yesterday** it had seemed **an** ordinary **affair**; **today** it was a **dear** one. “We **must thank** the **training**, and we **must relate** the new figure to the old,” she said. It was **certainly** the better question, and **finally** they could say so — **an** answer they had been walking **through** since the **morning** of the first day, for a **century**.

中文翻译

更好的问题来自一位在乡村车站候车的行人，时令已晚。“你们明白在这里走到车站代表什么吗？”她问，“在乡下，走路不是锻炼。它是对待整个世界的完整方式。”团队有一个事实、一个日期和一百年的假设，而没有一样能回答她。

皇家招待会、农业简报和本地锦标赛都被报道过；奖学金和研究员职位没有。“合伙人不等于教练，”那位水手说，“实习生也不等于奖章。”他们的制服、他们的曲调和他们与这座城市的一段浪漫，是这份报告的背景，而这份报告讨好的是错误的人。

那个戏剧性的插曲，是一通电话：赞助人把会员名单丢给了首都的一台发射机。“我为行人说话，”艾莎说，“他独自一人，而他不是幅漫画。”这是一句描述性的句子，不是学术性的，却是整份文件里最好的一句。

那个错误的假设是：数字上的花哨意味着服务兴旺。“队伍的陪伴不是分期付款计划，”教练说，“你无法用一张电子表格引导一个村庄。”客栈里那位腼腆的年轻人、老线路上的最后一位水手，以及前台接待处的经理，都同意他的看法。

会后，团队不再写殖民主义，而开始写那个车站本身：谁在那里等、他们带着什么、他们等了多久。这当然是个更小的问题，而它终于是对的那个。他们感谢了那位行人，把数字在整月里重新跑了一遍，并把她的那句话放在了开头。毕竟日期还远，而这件事情很可能会拖到下一个月。昨天它看起来还是一件平常事；今天它变得贵重了。“我们必须感谢那项培训，也必须把新的数字与旧的数字联系起来，”她说。这当然是那个更好的问题，而他们终于可以说出来了——一个他们从第一天早上起就一直在走进来的答案，走了一个世纪。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
fact fækt POS: n	n. 事实, 真实性, 真相, 细节, 论据 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a piece of information about circumstances that exist or events that have occurred; n. a statement or asser...
late leɪt POS: a	a. 迟的, 晚的, 已故的; adv. 很晚, 很迟, 晚 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. being or occurring at an advanced period of time or after a usual or expected time; s. of the immediate pas...
understand ˌʌndə'stænd POS: vt	vt. 理解, 了解, 领会, 听说, 懂; vi. 懂得, 认为 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. know and comprehend the nature or meaning of; v. perceive (an idea or situation) mentally; v. make sense of...
stop stɒp POS: n	n. 停止, 车站, 逗留, 填塞, 障碍, (风琴的)音栓; vi. 停止, 被塞住; vt. 塞住, 堵塞, 阻止, 击落, 停止, 终止... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the event of something ending; n. the act of stopping something; n. a brief stay in the course of a journey; ...
speak spi:k POS: vi	vi. 说, 说话, 演说, 发言; vt. 说, 讲, 说出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. use language; v. make a characteristic or natural sound
walk wɔ:k POS: n	n. 走, 散步, 步行, 行走的路程, 竞走, 散步场所; vi. 走路, 步行, 处世; vt. 走过, 遛, 使走, 护送...走 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of traveling by foot; n. manner of walking; n. the act of walking somewhere; n. a path set aside for...
short ʃɔ:t POS: a	a. 短的, 近的, 矮的, 短期的, 简短的, 少量的; adv. 简短地, 突然; n. 扼要, 短片, 缺乏; vt. 故意少给, 使短路 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the location on a baseball field where the shortstop is stationed; a. primarily temporal sense; indicating...
season 'si:zn POS: n	n. 季节, 时节, 当令期, 时期; vt. 给...调味, 使成熟, 使老练, 缓和; vi. 变干燥 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a period of the year marked by special events or activities in some field; n. one of the natural periods in...
approach ə'prəʊtʃ POS: n	n. 接近, 入门; vt. 接近, 近似, 找...商量; vi. 靠近 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. ideas or actions intended to deal with a problem or situation; n. the act of drawing spatially closer to so...
royal 'rɔɪəl POS: n	n. 王室, 皇族; a. 王室的, 皇家的, 盛大的, 庄严的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sail set next above the topgallant on a royal mast; n. stag with antlers of 12 or more branches; a. of or...
relate rɪ'leɪt POS: vt	vt. 讲, 叙述, 使互相关联; vi. 有关, 符合, 相处得好 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. give an account of; v. be in a relationship with; v. have or establish a relationship to
affair ə'feə POS: n	n. 事件, 事务, 恋爱事件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a usually secretive or illicit sexual relationship; n. a vaguely specified social event
partner 'pɑ:tənə POS: n	n. 合伙人, 股东, 伙伴, 伴侣; vt. 与...合伙, 组成一对; vi. 做伙伴, 当助手 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who is a member of a partnership; v. provide with a partner; v. act as a partner
alone ə'ləʊn POS: a	a. 孤独的, 单独的, 独自的; adv. 独自地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. isolated from others; s. lacking companions or companionship; s. exclusive of anyone or anything else; s. rad...
telephone 'telɪfəʊn POS: n	n. 电话, 电话机; v. 打电话 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. electronic equipment that converts sound into electrical signals that can be transmitted over distances an...
background 'bækgraʊnd POS: n	n. 背景, 背景资料; [计] 背景, 后台 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person's social heritage: previous experience or training; n. the part of a scene (or picture) that lies...
rural 'ruərəl POS: a	a. 乡下的, 田园的, 乡村风味的; [法] 农村的, 乡村的, 有关农业的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. living in or characteristic of farming or country life; a. of or relating to the countryside as opposed to...
membership 'membəʃɪp POS: n	n. 会员的资格, 全体会员, 会员数目; [法] 会员资格, 成员资格, 会籍 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the body of members of an organization or group; n. the state of being a member
championship 'tʃæmpɪənʃɪp POS: n	n. 冠军身份, 冠军称号, 捍卫 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the status of being a champion; n. a competition at which a champion is chosen
abandon ə'bændən POS: vt	vt. 放弃, 抛弃, 遗弃, 使屈从, 沉溺, 放纵; n. 放任, 无拘束, 狂热 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the trait of lacking restraint or control; reckless freedom from inhibition or worry; v. forsake, leave beh...
dramatic drə'mætɪk POS: a	a. 戏剧性的, 生动的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. suitable to or characteristic of drama; s. sensational in appearance or thrilling in effect; a. pertaining t...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
dear 'diə POS: n	n. 亲爱的人; a. 亲爱的, 昂贵的, 严重的, 急迫的; interj. 啊; adv. 深爱地, 高价地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. with or in a close or intimate relationship; s. earnest
agricultural ,ægrɪ'kʌltʃərəl POS: a	a. 农业的; [法] 农业的, 耕作的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or used in or promoting agriculture or farming
countryside 'kʌntrisaɪd POS: n	n. 乡下地方, 乡下居民 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. rural regions
episode 'epɪsəʊd POS: n	n. 插曲, 插话, 有趣的事件, 一段情节; [医] 插话, 插曲, 发作 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a happening that is distinctive in a series of related events; n. a brief section of a literary or dramatic...
reception rɪ'sepʃən POS: n	n. 接待, 接受, 招待会; [医] 接受, 感受 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the manner in which something is greeted; n. a formal party of people; as after a wedding; n. quality or fid...
uniform 'ju:nɪfɔ:m POS: n	n. 制服; a. 统一的, 一律的, 始终如一的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. clothing of distinctive design worn by members of a particular group as a means of identification; v. provi...
medal 'medl POS: n	n. 奖牌, 勋章; vt. 授勋予 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n an award for winning a championship or commemorating some other event
tune tju:n POS: n	n. 歌曲, 主旋律, 心情, 声调, 和谐, 一致, 语调, 程度; vt. 为...调音, 调整, 调谐, 使一致; vi. 协调, 调谐 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a succession of notes forming a distinctive sequence; n. the property of producing accurately a note of a g...
trainer 'treɪnə POS: n	n. 训练员, 驯马师; [电] 列车器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one who trains other persons or animals
romance rəu'mæns POS: n	n. 冒险故事, 浪漫史, 传奇文学; vi. 写传奇, 作空想, 虚构 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the group of languages derived from Latin; n. a novel dealing with idealized events remote from everyday li...
cartoon kɑ:'tu:n POS: n	n. 卡通画, 漫画; v. 画漫画 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a humorous or satirical drawing published in a newspaper or magazine; n. a film made by photographing a ser...
steer stiə POS: vt	vt. 引导, 驾驶, 航行, 控制; vi. 驾驶, 掌舵, 行驶; n. 驾驶指示, 劝告 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. direct the course; determine the direction of travelling; v. direct (oneself) somewhere
trainee treɪ'ni: POS: n	n. 实习生, 新兵, 受培训者; [经] 学徒工, 培训人员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who is being trained
sailor 'seɪlə POS: n	n. 水手, 船员, 海员; [法] 水手, 船员, 海员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any member of a ship's crew
flourish 'flaɪrɪʃ POS: vi	vi. 繁荣, 茂盛, 活跃, 手舞足蹈; vt. 挥舞, 夸耀; n. 挥舞, 炫耀, 茂盛, 兴旺, 华丽词藻 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a showy gesture; n. an ornamental embellishment in writing; n. a display of ornamental speech or language; n. ...
bulletin 'bʊlɪtɪn POS: n	n. 公告, 布告, 公报; [电] 电子布告栏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a brief report (especially an official statement issued for immediate publication or broadcast); v. make pu...
pedestrian pe'destriən POS: n	n. 行人, 步行者; a. 人行的, 徒步的, 呆板的, 通俗的, 平淡无奇的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who travels by foot; s. lacking wit or imagination
scholarly 'skɒləli POS: a	a. 学者派头的, 学者风度的, 有学问的, 博学的, 好学的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. characteristic of scholars or scholarship
descriptive dɪ'skriptɪv POS: a	a. 描述的, 叙述的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. serving to describe or inform or characterized by description; a. describing the structure of a language
instalment ɪn'stɔ:lmənt POS: n	n. 就职, 装设, 分期付款 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a part of a broadcast serial; n a part of a published serial; n the act of installing something (as equipment)
reserved rɪ'zə:vɪd POS: a	a. 保留的, 预备的, 预定的, 腼腆的, 不露感情的, 含蓄的, 缄默的, 冷淡的; [法] 用作储备的, 保留的, 预定的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. set aside for the use of a particular person or party; a. marked by self-restraint and reticence
transmitter træns'mɪtə POS: n	n. 传送者, 传达人, (疾病的)传播者; [计] 发散机; 发送器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. set used to broadcast radio or tv signals

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
colonialism kə'leɪnjəlɪzəm POS: n	n. 殖民主义 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. exploitation by a stronger country of weaker one; the use of the weaker country's resources to strengthen...
companionship kəm'pænjənʃɪp POS: n	n. 交往, 友谊, 一群同伴 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the state of being with someone